

Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

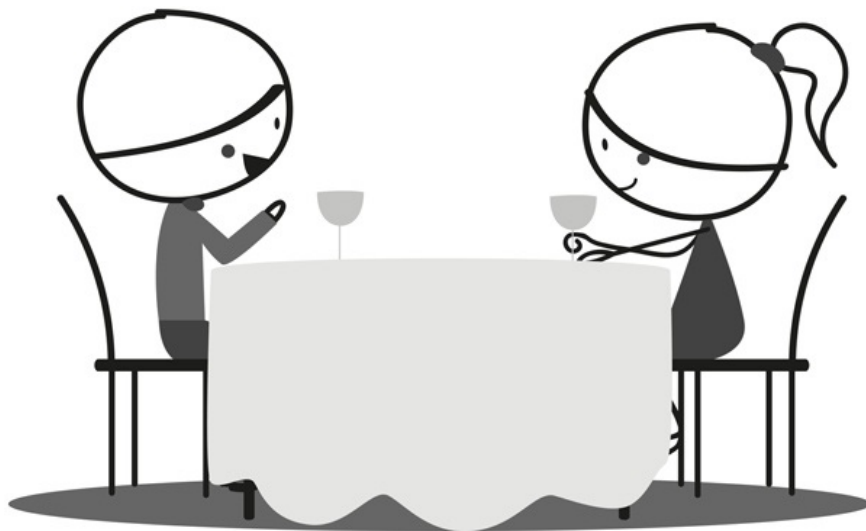
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Let's Start!

Pronunciation Spot: What lifestyles the rich and famous have!



Learning Outcome

Identify and describe issues relating to money, in written and spoken situations according to work and social contexts.

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about fame and work.
- I can use different tones to stress, contrast or emphasize information.
- I can say and use *could've* and *would've*.

Ask your partner:

- If you could have dinner with a famous celebrity, who would you choose?
- Can money and fame change a person? How?





Let's Explore!

Sally and Bip have a **stress***ful conversation!

* "Stress" can mean either to feel pressure or to emphasize a word.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Sally:** I'm here with Bip Fiddle, famous ...
- Bip:** Famous? I don't know about that. Infamous, maybe.
- Sally:** Well, let's go with notable, then. Does that work?
- Bip:** Some might say more notorious than notable, but sure, whatever floats your boat, baby.
- Sally:** My name is Sally Davis. You can call me Ms. Davis or Sally, but definitely not baby.
- Bip:** Alright, Sally. If I'd known you were such a stickler, I would've been more careful. The last thing I need is more bad press.
- Sally:** Has the media been tough on you?
- Bip:** Have they? They reported that I missed a concert because I went on a three-day bender.
- Sally:** And? Was it true?
- Bip:** Of course it was true, but they didn't have to report it. Anyway, it was a two-day bender, not three.
- Sally:** Oh, so they sensationalized it, did they?
- Bip:** They could've focused on the positive. Like how I sang at the children's hospital ...
- Sally:** As part of your court-mandated probation, if I recall ...
- Bip:** Still, I could've just skipped it, like I did that concert.
- Sally:** Well, this doesn't sound like bad press to me. It sounds like your bad attitude might've been a factor in their reporting.
- Bip:** So, now you're on their side?
- Sally:** Well I am a blogger. We're press too you know ...
- Bip:** Blogger? I thought you were a dog walker! I must've got my schedule mixed up. I really need to fire my publicist. Bye Sandy!
- Sally:** For the last time, it's Sally!





Let's Practice!

Put the emphasis* on the right syllable.

*"Emphasis" is the extra force that is given to a particular part of a word.

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Famous? (*FAMous*) I don't know about that. Infamous (*INfamous*), maybe.

Well, let's go with notable (*NOTABLE*), then. Does that (*THAT*) work?

You can call me Ms. Davis (*Ms. DAVIS*) or Sally (*SALLY*), but definitely not (*NOT*) baby.

Of course it was true, but they didn't have to report (*rePORT*) it.

For the last time, it's Sally (*SALLY*).



Let's Practice!

Sally and Bip talk about fame.

Instructions: Use the words from the box to correctly complete the sentences. Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

Word Bank

publicist / bad press / media / members of the press / sensationalize

1. The last thing I need is more _____.
2. Has _____ been tough on you?
3. Did they _____ the story?
4. Bloggers are _____.
5. I really need to fire my _____.





Extension Activity

Create a list of questions to ask a celebrity.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- Pretend you run your own blog and you are about to interview your favorite celebrity.
- Choose a celebrity to interview. It can be anyone, living or dead.
- Write a minimum of ten questions to ask.
- Role-play the interview with your partner playing the part of the celebrity.
- If they answer any of the questions incorrectly, correct them by stressing the appropriate answer.
- Reverse the roles and try again.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I write a list of questions to ask a famous celebrity.

☐ ☐

I conduct an interview with a celebrity.

☐ ☐

I provide feedback using stress.

☐ ☐

I respond to interview questions.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- **infamous** (adjective): famous for something which is considered bad
e.g. The musician had some infamous parties.
- **notorious** (adjective): known for something bad
e.g. He's notorious for missing concerts.
- **bad press** (expression): when negative things are published about someone or something in a newspaper or on television
e.g. He received a lot of bad press after the scandal.
- **media** (noun): television, Internet, newspapers, magazines and radio combined as a group
e.g. Has the media been tough on you?
- **to sensationalize** (verb): to embellish in order to make more exciting
e.g. They sensationalized the story.
- **press** (noun): those who report or publish the news (newspapers, television, radio, etc.)
e.g. As a blogger, I am also part of the press.
- **publicist** (noun): someone responsible for increasing the popularity of a person or company
e.g. I really need to fire my publicist.





Learning Points

Tonic, Contrastive, Emphatic and New Information Stress

There are various types of stress used when speaking English.

Tonic stress refers to the syllable in a word which receives the most stress in an intonation unit.

*Well, let's go with **notable**.*

When you want to point out the difference between one object and another, you use **contrastive stress**. It tends to be used with determiners such as 'this', 'that', 'these' and 'those'.

For example:

*Anyway, it was a **two**-day bender, not **three**.*

To emphasize a word, you can change the stress from the principal word to another content word. By choosing a word other than the one you normally stress, you put emphasis on the new one.

For example:

*You can call me Ms. Davis or Sally, but definitely **not** baby.*

Sentence stress gives English its rhythm or "beat".

When you **stress new information**, you pronounce it with more breath force, since it is more prominent.





Learning Points

Reduction of Have in Past Modals and in Auxiliary Verbs

When you use auxiliary verbs like *have*, it is common to reduce it in conversation.

In English, not every word or syllable is pronounced fully.

When you reduce the sound of *have* it sounds like **uv** or **iv**.

Read each sentence in its full form:

I **could have** just skipped it, like I did that concert.

It sounds like your bad attitude **might have** been a factor in their reporting.

I **must have** got my schedule mixed up.

I **would have** been more careful.

Now read them and reduce the pronunciation of the auxiliary verb *have*:

I **could've** just skipped it, like I did that concert. could_uv

It sounds like your bad attitude **might've** been a factor in their reporting. might_uv

I **must've** got my schedule mixed up. must_uv

I **would've** been more careful. would_uv

